

PART OF SEED SAVING FOR THE BACKYARD GARDENER

Printable Seed Bank Kit

Keep your home seed bank in order, one envelope at a time.

What is in here

- **Seed Chart.** All 30 plants on one sheet: isolation distance, how many plants to save from, seed life and when to harvest.
- **What Crosses.** One page on which plants cross with each other and which do not.
- **Seed Inventory.** One list of every variety you save and how it tested.
- **30 seed envelope labels, filled in.** One for each plant in the book, with its typical seed life and the page of its profile. You add the variety, the year and the number of parent plants.
- **10 blank labels** for anything else you save.
- **Germination Log.** A record of your tests, year after year.

How to print

Print at **100% scale** or **Actual size**, not *Fit to page*, or the labels will come out slightly small. Black and white is fine: every sheet stays readable without color.

The labels are 2 x 4 inches, ten per sheet, on the layout of the most common US label sheets (Avery 5163 and compatibles). Plain paper works too: cut along the outlines and attach with a glue stick.

Print only the sheets you need. The inventory and the log can be printed again as you fill them.

> **Label the envelope before you fill it.** Two envelopes of tan seed look exactly alike a year later.

Seed Chart

All 30 plants at a glance, from the tables on page 126 of the book. Pin it up where you clean your seed. Distances and plant numbers follow published seed-saving guidelines; seed life figures are typical averages under cool, dry storage, not promises. Always test older seed before you sow.

PLANT	CYCLE	ISOLATION BETWEEN VARIETIES	MIN. PLANTS	BEST PLANTS	SEED LIFE	HARVEST WHEN	PAGE
Tomato	Annual	10 to 50 feet	1	5 to 10	3 to 4 years	Fruit fully ripe, even a little past eating stage	40
Bean	Annual	10 to 20 feet	1	5 to 10	3 to 4 years	Pods tan, dry and papery; seeds rattle	44
Pea	Annual	10 to 20 feet	1	5 to 10	3 to 4 years	Pods tan, dry and papery; seeds rattle	46
Lettuce	Annual	10 to 20 feet	1	5 to 10	1 to 3 years	Flower heads turn into white, fluffy tufts	48
Pepper	Annual	300 to 1,600 feet, or bag flowers	1	5 to 20	1 to 3 years	Fruit reaches full ripe color and begins to soften	50
Eggplant	Annual	300 to 1,600 feet, or bag flowers	1	5 to 20	3 to 4 years	Skin dull, hard and brown or yellow, well past eating stage	52
Okra	Annual	500 to 1,600 feet, or bag flowers	1	5 to 10	1 to 3 years	Pods brown, dry and starting to split	54
Basil	Annual	At least 150 feet; one variety for purity	Several	As many as you can	5 years or more	Flower spikes or heads brown and dry	56
Dill	Annual	800 feet to 1/2 mile	5	20 to 50	3 to 4 years	Flower spikes or heads brown and dry	58
Sunflower	Annual	800 feet to 1/2 mile	5	20 to 50	3 to 4 years	Back of head yellow-brown, head droops, seeds plump	60
Marigold	Annual	No published distance; one variety per season or bag heads	Several	As many as you can	3 to 4 years	Flower head dry, base or stem below it brown	62
Zinnia	Annual	Several hundred feet, or one variety per season	Several	As many as you can	3 to 4 years	Flower head dry, base or stem below it brown	64
Cucumber	Annual	800 feet to 1/2 mile, or hand-pollinate	1	5 to 10	5 years or more	Fruit yellow to brown and soft, weeks past eating stage	69
Summer Squash and Zucchini	Annual	800 feet to 1/2 mile, or hand-pollinate	1	5 to 10	3 to 4 years	Rind hard; then cure 3 weeks indoors	71
Winter Squash and Pumpkin	Annual	800 feet to 1/2 mile, or hand-pollinate	1	5 to 10	3 to 4 years	Fully mature; cure 3 weeks or more	73
Melon	Annual	800 feet to 1/2 mile, or hand-pollinate	1	5 to 10	5 years or more	Ripe to eat	75
Watermelon	Annual	800 feet to 1/2 mile, or hand-pollinate	1	5 to 10	3 to 4 years	Ripe to eat	77
Tomatillo	Annual	800 feet to 1/2 mile	5	20 to 50	3 to 4 years	Husk dry and papery, fruit fills or splits it	79
Radish	Annual	800 feet to 1/2 mile	5	20 to 50	3 to 4 years	Most pods tan and dry	81
Arugula	Annual	800 feet to 1/2 mile	5	20 to 50	3 to 4 years	Most pods tan and dry	83
Cilantro	Annual	800 feet to 1/2 mile	5	20 to 50	5 years or more	Flower spikes or heads brown and dry	85
Chives	Perennial	800 feet to 1/2 mile	5	20 to 50	1 year	Capsules split and show black seed	87
Carrot	Biennial	800 feet to 1/2 mile, also from Queen Anne's lace	5	20 to 50	1 to 3 years	Seed head brown and curled inward like a nest	91
Beet and Swiss Chard	Biennial	800 feet to 1 mile	5	20 to 50	3 to 4 years	Lowest seed clusters brown and hard	94
Onion	Biennial	800 feet to 1/2 mile	5	20 to 50	1 year	Capsules open and show black seed	96
Kale and Collards	Biennial	800 feet to 1/2 mile	5	20 to 50	3 to 4 years	Most pods tan and dry	98
Cabbage and Broccoli	Biennial	800 feet to 1/2 mile	5	20 to 50	3 to 4 years	Most pods tan and dry	100
Corn	Annual	800 feet to 1/2 mile, or stagger planting times	10	50 to 120	1 to 3 years	Husks brown and dry, kernels hard	102
Spinach	Annual	800 feet to 1 mile	10	20 to 50	3 to 4 years	Lowest seed clusters brown and hard	104
Parsley	Biennial	800 feet to 1/2 mile	5	20 to 50	1 year	Flower spikes or heads brown and dry	106

What Crosses

Will two plants in your garden cross? Find them here. Isolation distances for each plant are on the Seed Chart. This is Table 2, on page 127 of the book.

THESE CROSS WITH EACH OTHER	THESE DO NOT CROSS WITH THEM
All Cucurbita pepo: zucchini, yellow squash, acorn, delicata, many carving pumpkins	Butternut (C. moschata), Hubbard and buttercup (C. maxima)
All melons: muskmelon, cantaloupe, honeydew, Armenian cucumber	Watermelon, cucumber
Watermelon and citron melon	Melon, cucumber, squash
All cucumbers	Melon, watermelon, squash
Beet, Swiss chard, sugar beet	Spinach
Kale, collards, cabbage, broccoli, cauliflower, Brussels sprouts, kohlrabi	Siberian kale, rutabaga, turnip, radish
Carrot and wild Queen Anne's lace	Parsley, dill, cilantro
Sweet corn, field corn, flint corn, popcorn	Nothing else in this book
All radishes, including daikon and wild radish	Cabbage-family greens
Curly, flat-leaf and root parsley	Carrot
Onion varieties	Leeks, chives, garlic chives
Sweet and hot peppers of the same species	Tomato, eggplant

Biennials need two seasons. Carrot, Beet and Swiss Chard, Onion, Kale and Collards, Cabbage and Broccoli, Parsley: the first year for the plant and the second for the seed. Check the profile of each one in the book.

Seed Inventory

One row for each variety in your seed bank. Update it each fall, when the new seed goes in. Chapter 10 of the book, on page 113, shows how to keep the bank in order.

PLANT	VARIETY	YEAR SAVED	PARENT PLANTS	AMOUNT	LAST TEST	NOTES

Tomato

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically 4 years, and up to about 6 when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 40

Bean

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 3 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 44

Pea

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 3 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 46

Lettuce

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Short-lived. Plan on about 1 to 3 years, and test before you sow.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 48

Pepper

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 2 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 50

Eggplant

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 4 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 52

Okra

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 2 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 54

Basil

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Often 5 years or more when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 56

Dill

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 3 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 58

Sunflower

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 3 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 60

Marigold

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 3 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 62

Zinnia

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically 3 to 5 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 64

Cucumber

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 5 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 69

Summer Squash and Zucchini

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 4 years when stored cool and dry.

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Winter Squash and Pumpkin

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 4 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 73

Melon

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 5 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 75

Watermelon

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 4 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 77

Tomatillo

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Often 3 to 4 years when stored cool and dry. Test before you sow.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 79

Radish

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 4 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 81

Arugula

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Often 3 to 6 years when stored cool and dry. Test before you sow.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 83

Cilantro

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Often 5 years or more when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 85

Chives

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Short-lived. Plan on about 1 year, and sow fresh seed.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 87

Carrot

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Short-lived. Plan on about 1 to 3 years, and test before you sow.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 91

Beet and Swiss Chard

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 4 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 94

Onion

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Short-lived. Plan on about 1 year, and sow fresh seed.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 96

Kale and Collards

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 4 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 98

Cabbage and Broccoli

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 4 years for cabbage and about 3 for broccoli, when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 100

Corn

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 2 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 102

Spinach

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Typically about 3 years when stored cool and dry.

Seed Saving for the Backyard Gardener Profile, page 104

Parsley

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

SEED LIFE Short-lived. Plan on about 1 year, and sow fresh seed.

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PLANT _____

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

NOTES _____

PLANT _____

VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

NOTES _____

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VARIETY _____

YEAR _____ PARENT PLANTS _____

NOTES _____

Germination Log

The method is on page 34 of the book. To get the percent, divide the seeds that sprouted by the seeds you tested: 7 out of 10 is 70%.

DATE	PLANT AND VARIETY	YEAR SAVED	SEEDS TESTED	SPROUTED	PERCENT	NOTES